

Once the installation is complete, go to your Applications folder and double-click on Xcode, then install any required components if asked to. However, since OS X 10.7 (Lion) is the last to support a free installation of Xcode, you'll have to make sure you have an updated version running on your Mac so as to have to avoid paying much for Xcode. For those running OS X 10.6 (Snow Leopard), the last highest version of Xcode you can install for free is Xcode 3.2.6, so you'll have to make sure you're using the version that is guaranteed to work on your OS version.

Installing Xcode for Mac users is not a hassle. It's the PC/Linux owners who are in for a world of pain. Even though Apple, officially speaking, requires that all iOS apps be built on Mac OS X, there are a few workarounds available. A fair word of warning – it's imperative that you test your app on a legitimate Apple device running your target platform, since, at the end of the day, a simulator cannot provide the hardware and working software to ensure your device will run smoothly on the end user's device. Moreover, considering how strict Apple is with regards to its design guidelines, it would benefit developers to take a look at the multitude of apps currently available in the App Store and familiarise themselves with what is expected in terms of design and the user interface.

If you're still adamant on using a non-Apple device to develop your app on, there are two ways to go about this.

The first workaround is to use a Virtual Machine (VM). A system virtual machine provides a complete system platform which supports the execution of a complete operating system. These usually emulate an existing architecture, and are built with the purpose of either providing a platform to run programs where the real hardware is not available for use, or of having multiple instances of virtual machines leading to more efficient use of computing resources. Popular VM softwares include Oracle's VirtualBox and VMware. Since the latter is a paid software, most people opt for Oracle's VirtualBox. To use your VM to run Mac, you'll also need to obtain a paid version of OS X, preferably version 10.7 and above. Unfortunately, there is no way to obtain a legal version of any OS X Mavericks onwards, since Apple has changed the format of the ESD image that is used for installation on Mac machines. Moreover, the paid versions do not install easy and a lot of issues crop up post-installation. This is why many users recommend using pirated OS X versions with modified code that allow easy installation. However, since such "distros", as they are called, are illegal, and violate copyright law, you must use your discretion before trying out this method.